

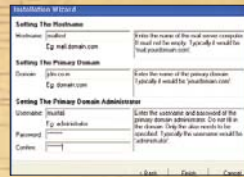
E-Mail Server Software

Merak Mail Lite 7.0.1

Our Verdict: Merak Mail Lite has a conventional application-based interface that is quite similar to the browser-based admin interface. Even though it did not have an inbuilt dialler, it integrated well with the one that comes with Windows. This software allows you to restrict users as per the size of their mails and also the number of

mails per day. These little features help you manage your mail traffic on the Intranet. Merak Mail Lite excelled in identifying spam. The software bundles along goodies like calendaring server and an instant messaging server.

Runner-up: **MDaemon**



Firewall

ZoneLabs ZoneAlarm

Our Verdict: ZoneAlarm Pro 5.5 from Zone Labs is the best software firewall available to desktop users for personal use. ZoneAlarm is significantly better than its competitors, and the all familiar tabbed interface is extremely simple to use. Zone Labs have reduced the irritating confirmation pop-ups that are still a pain with other

products. The firewall protection is effective against inbound and outbound traffic. It is highly resilient to attacks and difficult to fool around with—even a manual shutdown of process does not put ZoneAlarm off track.

Runner-up: **Norton Personal Firewall 2005**



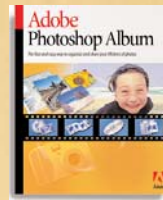
Image Management

Adobe Photoshop Album 2.0

Our Verdict: Adobe's Photoshop Album 2.0 is a sequel to the original Photoshop Album 1.0 that marked Adobe's entry in the image management arena. While retaining most of the features from the older version, Album 2.0 has few new features to talk about. The timeline that runs across the top shows the number of photos taken in a month as drop down bars. The main win-

dow shows thumbnails of your photos and a slider lets you control the size of the thumbnail—a new feature. Image editing tools are good for a program of this level, but you may be disappointed if you are used to Adobe Photoshop. Overall, an excellent tool but upgrading is not recommended since there are hardly any new features to pay for.

Runner-up: **ACDSee 7**



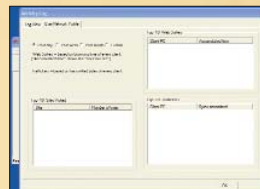
Internet Sharing Software

Sygate Office Network

Our Verdict: Sygate Office Network is one of the best network management software you could come across. It is loaded with features and sports an extremely simple user interface. The software has more features than any other contender in this category—something a network administrator would love. The 'Disconnect If Idle' feature is particularly useful: the server keeps constant track of users, and if one of them is idle for a cer-

tain time, the connection is freed up for someone else to use. This helps reduce dial-up costs. The activity log is the best across the board, with real-time monitoring and a history viewer, in addition to auditing. This is a true professional internet sharing software.

Runner-up: **WinGate**



Firewall

Evolution: With the rapid deployment of networking across corporations and homes, unauthorised access to your PC is a real threat. Firewalls protect your PCs from malicious attacks, such as port scans, ping, floods and other new threats and inform you of

unauthorised traffic flow. Four years ago, Norton's Personal Firewall 2000 provided the necessary deterrence. Fast forward to 2004 and we have Zone Labs ZoneAlarm Pro 5.5 coming out as the best available firewall on the market today and exceeding even WinGate.

